Babur led the horrific path along with his other fifteen trusted strong households. Those included Qāsim Beg, his sons Tīngrī-bīrdī and Qaṃbar-i-‘alī and two or three of their retainers. They would walk around seven to eight yards, stamping the snow down at each step and they would sink to almost their breast. After those few steps, the leading man would stand still, exhausted and consumed by the terrific labour. Then the second one would follow, and the process would go on and on. By the time fifteen to twenty men would have stamped the snow down, it became at least feasible enough to ride a horse over it. However, the horse would sink to the stirrups and couldn’t do more than a dozen of steps or so. Then that horse would be set aside and the other would be made to follow the same procedure. After those fifteen to twenty men would have stamped the snow and had led horses, the remaining troop would slog in the beaten track.

Babur had clearly understood the value of the hardship. He has mentioned, ‘It was not a time to urge or compel! The man with will and hardihood for such tasks does them by his own request!’

Stamping the snow down this way, Babur and his men got out from there finally and in next four days reached to a cave known as the Khawāl-i-qūtī below the Zirrīn pass.

Perhaps, it was just very right time when Babur and his men made to the cave. The very night, the snowstorm came so ferociously that it only projected end of every man’s life.[*]

> That night the snow fell in such an amazing blizzard of cutting wind that every man feared for his life.

The snowstorm had become too violent by the time they had reached the cave. Babur and his men dismounted at the orifice of the cave. Babur has described the situation as follows:

> Deep snow! a one-man road! and even on that stamped-down and trampled road, pitfalls for horses! the days at their shortest!

Hence people kept arriving in batches. The first batch along with Babur had reached in the daylight although the environs appeared extremely gloomy and scary. The second batch arrived in time for the evening prayer and the batches kept coming till the night. Many couldn’t make it to the cave and dismounted wherever they could. They all feared for their lives on this ghostly night of the sharpest storm. Dawn had broken yet many still lay in the saddle.